

December

8

Antarctic concert

With a show called Freeze 'Em All in Antarctica, US heavy metal band Metallica became the first band to play a concert in all seven continents. Because of Antarctica's fragile ecosystem, the sound was transferred from amplifiers directly to headphones worn by the crowd.



2020

Measuring Everest

The height of Mount Everest was officially revised to 8,848.86 m (29,031.69 ft) following a survey conducted by researchers in Nepal and China, countries which share a border that passes over the mountain.



2013



1881

Electric iron

US inventor Henry W Seely applied for a patent for the first electric iron.

This early device used electricity to generate a constant amount of heat, which was a huge improvement on irons heated on a stove.

Also on this day

1987 At a summit in Washington, DC, USA, Soviet leader Mikhail Gorbachev and US president Ronald Reagan agreed to cut down on their nuclear weapons, signalling a thawing of the Cold War.

2010 With the successful Dragon mission, SpaceX became the first private company to launch a spacecraft into Earth's orbit and then recover it.

2020 Ninety-year-old Margaret Keenan from Coventry, UK, became the first person to receive the COVID-19 vaccine outside clinical trials.

Born this day

1935 Dharmendra, Indian actor and film producer. A popular actor in Bollywood, he has starred in more than 300 films.